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AI Engineer

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Hiring Team
Aleph Alpha
Berlin / Heidelberg
Germany

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Application for AI R&D Engineer - Model Training

Dear Hiring Team,

I am writing to apply for the AI R&D Engineer - Model Training position at Aleph Alpha. I have a Master's in Artificial Intelligence and three years of experience building and deploying AI applications, and I want to move closer to the engineering behind the models themselves.

Your posting puts code quality first, so I will start there. At Kniit I was the sole developer of a knowledge-extraction pipeline for the German energy sector and owned it from ingestion to indexing. I built agentic, deterministic and monolithic extraction strategies inside one pipeline and compared them against each other. Precision and recall went from 33% and 45% to 93% and 90%, measured against ground truth from the customer's SAP system. I worked with Claude Code and clean-code principles throughout, and I want to bring the same habits to a codebase that other people depend on.

Evaluation work is part of your role, and it was the core of my Master's thesis at Covestro. I automated the evaluation of RAG generation and retrieval with RAGAS and PytrecEval, benchmarked multilingual embedding models on more than one million chunks, and fine-tuned models for retrieval in PyTorch and Hugging Face Transformers. Earlier I fine-tuned an Open Llama 3B model with QLoRA. That is small next to pre-training Kolibri, and I will not pretend otherwise, but it taught me where training and evaluation pipelines break.

On the infrastructure side, I have shipped Python services in Docker, deployed them to AWS with CDK and to Azure, and run continuous integration with GitLab CI/CD. Kubernetes is part of my Kniit stack. Test-driven development, trunk-based development and Rust are not things I can claim from past jobs, and I would like to learn them in a team that practises them every day, including through pair and mob programming.

Aleph Alpha is one of the few European teams that trains foundation models from scratch, and Kolibri-1 shows the pipeline works. I would like to help make it faster and easier to change, for models that fit European customers in finance, manufacturing and public administration.

I am based in Berlin, hold an EU Blue Card and can start on 15 November 2026. I am happy to be on site at least two days a week and to travel to Heidelberg. Thank you for considering my application.

Kind regards,

Chandu Prasad Bhairapu